



“NDA 3.0 HAS BEEN RELATIVELY QUIET ON REFORMS”

Richard Rossow, Senior Adviser and Chair on India and Emerging Asia Economics, Center for Strategic & International Studies, on why reforms have slowed under NDA 3.0 and what it would take for India to meet its 2047 goals

BY SIDDHARTH ZARABI



RICHARD ROSSOW, Senior Adviser and Chair on India and Emerging Asia Economics at Center for Strategic & International Studies, has been tracking India's reforms trajectory and businesses for the past 25 years. He also does a 30 reforms tracker that is followed across the world. *BT* spoke to him about strategies that can fast-track India's movement towards developed country status by 2047 and how it can position itself to take on China in manufacturing and other areas. Edited excerpts:

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How is Modi 3.0 performing on the reforms front?

When you look at the pace of reforms, whether FDI or domestic, it's been the slowest of the three terms (of the NDA government) so far. The first term saw a bunch of big reforms, about 40 positive changes to the foreign investment list, and some big domestic reforms such as GST and bankruptcy. The second term was a little slow, but when Covid hit, the government knew it needed to trigger the economy. You saw some tax changes, some FDI reforms. But this time, it's been relatively quiet. A part of that may be because they're now in a coalition government. You've had some changes to key Cabinet officials. But in the (ongoing) Parliament session, a couple of big things are on the horizon, a range of